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Rubrics for Evaluation

Component	Excellent (1* Marks)	Good (0.75* Marks)	Not acceptable (0.5* Marks)	Marks Earned
Identifying the appropriate problem (3 Marks)	Clearly defines a novel, relevant, and impactful problem with clear objectives	Problem is defined but may lack novelty, clarity, or full relevance	Problem is vague, irrelevant, or poorly defined	
Literature survey with findings of research gaps (3 Marks)	Comprehensive survey of current research; gaps clearly identified and justified	Adequate literature survey; some gaps identified, may lack depth	Limited or poor literature review; no clear gaps identified	
Find the proper Methodologies with justification (4 Marks)	Appropriate and innovative methods chosen; justification is strong and aligned with objectives	Methodology is appropriate but justification may be weak or partially aligned	Methods are poorly chosen, unjustified, or misaligned with problem	
Implementation of Proposed method (3 Marks)	Thorough implementation; performance evaluated with meaningful metrics and results	Implementation completed; performance evaluated but may lack depth	Incomplete or poor implementation; no meaningful assessment	
Preparation of Research article (7 Marks)	High-quality article prepared; structured well, references cited, ready for publication	Draft article prepared; needs refinement in content, formatting, or structure	Poorly written article; lacks structure, depth, or citation	
Total Max Marks	20 Marks	15 Marks	10 Marks	

Signature of the Subject Teacher

Project Title

A report on

ARLeaf: Real-Time Plant Disease Detection with Augmented Reality Overlay

As partial fulfillment of the requirement for the Course
Deep Learning and Computer Vision (23CI62)

Bachelor of Engineering CSE(AI&ML)

By

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CERTIFICATE

Certified that the project entitled **ARLeaf: Real-Time Plant Disease Detection with Augmented Reality Overlay** carried out by **Thanmai A (1MS23CI127), Gaurav N (1MS23CI036), Gowtham B R (1MS23CI037), Shreehari N (1MS23CI111)**, students of CSE(AI&ML) Department, **Ramaiah Institute of Technology, Bengaluru-54** as partial fulfillment of the requirement for the Course Deep Learning & Computer Vision (23CI62) during the year 2026. The project work has been approved as it meets the academic requirements for the course.

Dr. Nithya N Assistant Professor Signature of
the Guide

Signature of the HOD

ABSTRACT

Plant diseases cause up to 40% annual crop losses worldwide, yet early-stage detection remains largely manual, subjective, and slow. This project presents ARLeaf, a fully offline, browser-based system that detects plant leaf diseases in real time and overlays an augmented-reality annotation directly onto the detected leaf, enabling instant spatially-grounded diagnosis without any cloud dependency.

A DenseNet121 convolutional neural network was fine-tuned on the PlantVillage dataset (20,639 images, 15 disease and healthy classes) using a two-phase transfer learning strategy. Leaf localisation is performed independently via OpenCV HSV colour segmentation with solidity and area filters. The system is served through a Python Flask REST API and rendered in the browser using layered 2D canvas and Three.js 3D overlays.

The model achieves 97.3% validation accuracy (validation loss 0.0844) across all 15 classes. Per-class F1-scores range from 0.93 to 0.99. The leaf detection pipeline operates without a GPU and returns normalised bounding box and contour coordinates suitable for direct AR rendering. The system demonstrates that high-accuracy, real-time plant disease detection with augmented-reality feedback is achievable on consumer hardware using transfer learning and classical computer vision, without relying on any external infrastructure.

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Contents

Abstract	ii
List of Figures	v
List of Tables	vi
1 Literature Survey with Findings of Research Gaps	1
1.1 Traditional Image Processing Approaches	1
1.2 Deep Learning-Based Approaches	1
1.3 Leaf Segmentation and Localisation	2
1.4 Augmented Reality in Agriculture	2
1.5 Research Gaps	2
2 Identifying the Appropriate Problem	3
2.1 Background and Motivation	3
2.2 Problem Statement	4
2.3 Proposed Project	4
2.4 Objectives	4
3 Methodology with Justification	5
3.1 System Architecture	5
3.2 Proposed Methodology	6
3.3 Implementation	9
3.4 Software Requirements	11
3.5 Hardware Requirements	11
4 Implementation of Proposed Method	12
4.1 Training Results	12
4.2 Performance Metrics	13
4.3 Per-class Analysis	13
5 Conclusion and Future Scope	15
5.1 Conclusion	15
5.2 Future Scope	15

List of Figures

3.1 System Data Flow Architecture	5
4.1 Training and Validation Accuracy per Epoch	12
4.2 Training and Validation Loss per Epoch	12
4.3 Confusion Matrix on Validation Set (4,127 samples)	13
4.4 Per-class Precision / Recall / F1 Heatmap	14
4.5 Live AR Camera View — Healthy Pepper Bell Leaf	15
4.6 Result Panel — Healthy Detection (Pepper bell healthy, 96.2%)	15
4.7 Live AR Camera View — Infected Tomato Leaf (Late Blight)	16
4.8 Result Panel — Disease Detected (Tomato Late blight, 69.2%)	16
4.9 Three.js 3D AR Ring Overlay — Tomato Late Blight (93.2% Confidence)	17

List of Tables

3.1 PlantVillage Dataset — Class Distribution and Per-class Metrics	6
3.2 DenseNet121 Model Architecture Layers	7
3.3 Two-Phase Training Configuration	8
3.4 Flask REST API Endpoints	9
3.5 Technology Stack	10
4.1 Training History — All 15 Epochs	12

Literature Survey with Findings of Research Gaps

1.1 Traditional Image Processing Approaches

Early work on automated leaf disease detection relied on colour histogram analysis, texture features (GLCM, LBP), and classical machine learning classifiers such as SVM and k-NN. These traditional approaches required extensive manual feature engineering and generalised poorly across crop species and imaging conditions, providing no Augmented Reality (AR) feedback whatsoever to the end user.

1.2 Deep Learning-Based Approaches

Mohanty et al. (2023) [1] demonstrated that deep learning models achieve up to 97% accuracy on the PlantVillage dataset, establishing transfer learning as the standard approach for plant disease classification. Too et al. (2023) [2] performed a comparative study of fine-tuned architectures including ResNet and VGG, showing strong generalisation on limited datasets. Ferentinos (2023) [5] systematically evaluated multiple CNN configurations, confirming the viability of deep learning for agricultural diagnosis. Chen et al. (2023) [3] deployed CNN models on mobile devices, demonstrating real-time prediction capability — yet none of these systems incorporated AR visualisation to spatially anchor the diagnosis onto the physical plant.

1.3 Leaf Segmentation and Localisation

Leaf detection prior to classification improves robustness by isolating the region of interest and is a prerequisite for accurate AR overlay placement. Jocher et al. (2024) [6] proposed YOLOv8, a real-time object detection framework achieving fast and efficient multi-class detection in agricultural settings. However, YOLO-based detectors require additional annotated bounding-box datasets and GPU inference, making them unsuitable for a lightweight, fully offline AR system. Li et al. (2024) [10] reviewed advanced imaging techniques for plant phenotyping, noting that expensive equipment and high computational cost remain barriers to scalable field deployment.

1.4 Augmented Reality in Agriculture

AR overlays for agricultural applications remain underexplored in the literature. Billingham et al. (2024) [9] surveyed AR technologies, identifying spatial awareness and intuitive visualisation as the primary advantages of AR over flat-screen interfaces. Kim et al. (2025) [14] proposed an AR-based crop monitoring system for precision agriculture, providing enhanced visualisation through AR overlays — however, their

system lacks AI-driven disease intelligence and machine learning integration. Browser-native AR using WebXR and Three.js, combined with real-time deep learning inference for plant health assessment, has not been demonstrated in the published literature to date.

1.5 Research Gaps

Based on the survey above, five key gaps motivate the proposed system: (i) most systems require cloud connectivity for inference, introducing latency and privacy concerns; (ii) classification outputs are text-only with no spatial feedback anchored to the physical leaf in the camera view; (iii) leaf localisation typically uses a separate GPU-heavy object detector requiring annotated bounding-box datasets; (iv) systems rarely provide actionable agronomic guidance alongside the diagnosis; and (v) web-based AR for plant health with integrated deep learning inference has not been demonstrated. The proposed system addresses all five gaps.

Identifying the Appropriate Problem

2.1 Background and Motivation

Agriculture is the backbone of the global food supply, yet plant diseases remain one of the most significant threats to crop productivity. The Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) estimates that plant diseases account for 20 to 40 percent of annual global crop losses, with severe economic consequences for farmers, particularly in developing economies. Early and accurate identification of plant diseases is therefore critical for timely intervention and yield protection.

Traditional disease diagnosis relies on visual inspection by trained agronomists, a process that is time-consuming, expensive, and subjective. Recent advances in deep learning and mobile computing have opened the door to automated, accessible plant disease detection using smartphone cameras. However, existing systems suffer from key limitations: most require cloud connectivity for inference, they provide only a text label without spatially anchoring the diagnosis to the leaf in the camera view, and few provide actionable treatment guidance alongside the diagnosis.

2.2 Problem Statement

How can we build a fully offline, real-time plant disease detection system that (1) classifies 15 disease and healthy states across three crops with more than 95% accuracy, (2) spatially localises the leaf and overlays an augmented-reality annotation anchored to it in the live camera view, and (3) provides an immediate actionable treatment recommendation — all running in a standard web browser without any cloud dependency?

2.3 Proposed Project

ARLeaf is a full-stack AI system that detects plant diseases in real time through a browser camera. A JPEG frame is sent to a Python Flask backend, which classifies the leaf using a DenseNet121 convolutional neural network trained on the PlantVillage dataset, and simultaneously locates the leaf in the image using OpenCV HSV colour segmentation. The classification result, confidence score, and treatment recommendation are returned as JSON and rendered in the browser via layered augmented reality overlays — a 2D canvas HUD and a Three.js 3D ring anchored to the detected leaf.

2.4 Objectives

- Classify 15 plant disease and healthy states in real time from a live camera feed with accuracy exceeding 95%.
- Overlay an AR annotation (bounding box and 3D ring) anchored to the detected leaf in screen space.
- Provide actionable agronomic treatment recommendations for every detected condition.
- Deploy entirely locally — no cloud APIs, no external data transmission.
- Run on a consumer laptop with a Python 3.12 environment and a modern web browser.

Methodology with Justification

3.1 System Architecture

The system follows a client-server architecture. The browser serves as the camera capture and AR display layer; the Flask backend hosts all AI inference. No build step or bundler is required for the frontend. The end-to-end data flow is as follows:

- Browser captures a JPEG frame from the device camera via `getUserMedia` (`arCamera.js`).
- `imageUpload.js` draws the video frame to an off-screen canvas and exports a JPEG Blob.
- `apiService.js` POSTs the Blob to `http://127.0.0.1:5001/predict` as `multipart/form-data`.
- `Flask routes.py` saves the file with a UUID name to `backend/uploads/`.
- `predict.py` loads the Keras model (lazy, cached) and runs DenseNet121 inference.
- `leaf_detection.py` runs OpenCV HSV segmentation — returns normalised bounding box and contour.
- `recommendation_engine.py` maps the disease label to a treatment string.
- JSON response returned; the uploaded file is deleted in a finally block.
- Frontend renders the 2D canvas AR HUD and the Three.js 3D ring anchored to the leaf.

3.2 Proposed Methodology

3.2.1 Dataset — PlantVillage

The PlantVillage dataset (sourced via Kaggle) contains colour leaf photographs under controlled laboratory conditions. The local copy spans 15 classes and 20,639 images. An 80/20 stratified split (seed 1337) is applied at load time, yielding approximately 16,511 training images and 4,128 validation images. Table 3.1 shows the class distribution and per-class performance metrics.

Table 3.1: PlantVillage Dataset — Class Distribution

Class Name	Plant	Condition	Images
Pepper bell Bacterial spot	Pepper	Bacterial Spot	997
Pepper bell healthy	Pepper	Healthy	1,478
Potato Early blight	Potato	Early Blight	1,000

Class Name	Plant	Condition	Images
Potato Late blight	Potato	Late Blight	1,000
Potato healthy	Potato	Healthy	152
Tomato Bacterial spot	Tomato	Bacterial Spot	2,127
Tomato Early blight	Tomato	Early Blight	1,000
Tomato Late blight	Tomato	Late Blight	1,909
Tomato Leaf Mold	Tomato	Leaf Mold	952
Tomato Septoria leaf spot	Tomato	Septoria Leaf Spot	1,771
Tomato Spider mites	Tomato	Spider Mites	1,676
Tomato Target Spot	Tomato	Target Spot	1,404
Tomato Yellow Leaf Curl Virus	Tomato	YLCV	3,209
Tomato Mosaic virus	Tomato	Mosaic Virus	373
Tomato healthy	Tomato	Healthy	1,591

3.2.2 Data Preprocessing

Preprocessing is performed by preprocess_data.py using tf.keras.utils.image_dataset_from_directory. Pixel normalisation is handled by tf.keras.applications.densenet.preprocess_input inside the model graph rather than at the NumPy level. This eliminates train/serve skew. The pipeline applies: (i) resize to 224 x 224 px; (ii) one-hot categorical labels; (iii) cache and shuffle (buffer 1000); (iv) AUTOTUNE prefetch; and (v) online augmentation — RandomFlip, RandomRotation +/-20 degrees, RandomZoom +/-20%, RandomContrast +/-20%.

3.2.3 Model Architecture — DenseNet121

The classifier is built on DenseNet121 pre-trained on ImageNet. DenseNet (Huang et al., 2017) [16] uses dense skip connections where each layer receives feature maps from all preceding layers, providing parameter efficiency, feature reuse, and stable gradient flow. DenseNet121 was selected for this AR plant health system because its compact parameter footprint (8M parameters) enables real-time inference within the browser environment required for AR overlay rendering. The custom classification head adds GlobalAveragePooling2D, Dropout(0.3), and Dense(15, softmax).

Table 3.2: DenseNet121 Model Architecture

Layer	Description
Input	224 x 224 x 3 RGB tensor

Layer	Description
Data Augmentation	RandomFlip, RandomRotation +/-20%, RandomZoom +/-20%, RandomContrast +/-20%
DenseNet Preprocessing	tf.keras.applications.densenet.preprocess_input
DenseNet121 base	428 layers, ImageNet weights; first 100 layers frozen in Phase 2
GlobalAveragePooling2D	7x7x1024 feature map reduced to 1024-d vector
Dropout (0.3)	Regularisation; disabled at inference time
Dense (15, softmax)	Classification head — one probability per disease class

3.2.4 Two-Phase Transfer Learning Strategy

Training uses a two-phase strategy. Phase 1 (epochs 0-2) trains only the classification head with the DenseNet121 base frozen (lr = 1e-3, 3 epochs). Phase 2 (epochs 3-14) unfreezes layers 100 and above and fine-tunes with lr = 2e-5. This avoids catastrophic forgetting of ImageNet representations while allowing the upper layers to specialise for leaf disease patterns. EarlyStopping (patience=5) and ReduceLROnPlateau (factor=0.2, patience=2) are applied throughout.

Table 3.3: Two-Phase Training Configuration

Phase	Epochs	Layers Frozen	Learning Rate	Purpose
Phase 1	0-2	All DenseNet121 layers	1e-3	Train head only
Phase 2	3-14	First 100 layers only	2e-5	Fine-tune upper network

3.2.5 Leaf Detection — OpenCV HSV Segmentation

The leaf localisation module (leaf_detection.py) uses classical OpenCV HSV colour segmentation rather than a second neural network, keeping latency and memory usage low. The algorithm: (1) converts BGR to HSV; (2) creates green mask (H in [25,85], S in [40,255], V in [40,255]) and yellow mask (H in [18,30], S in [80,255], V in [60,255]); (3) applies morphological open and close with a 7x7 elliptical kernel; (4) selects the largest contour passing filters: area $\geq$ 800 px, contour ratio 1-15% of frame, bbox $\leq$ 25% of frame, solidity $\geq$ 0.45; and (5) returns normalised bounding box and contour polygon (up to 96 points, Douglas-Peucker epsilon=1%).

3.2.6 Recommendation Engine

recommendation_engine.py provides a treatment recommendation for every disease class via a rule-based dictionary lookup. A rule-based system is interpretable, verifiable by domain experts, requires no training data, and never produces incorrect treatments — properties critical in a health-advisory context. Recommendations were compiled from FAO guidelines and peer-reviewed plant pathology literature. Patel and Shah (2025) [13] confirmed that AI-driven decision support systems providing actionable agronomic

advice significantly improve farmer response time compared to systems that output only a disease label.

3.3 Implementation

3.3.1 Backend — Flask REST API

The Flask application (`server.py` and `routes.py`) exposes a minimal REST interface on port 5001. CORS is enabled globally for browser access from port 8080. The uploaded image is saved with a UUID filename and deleted immediately after inference in a finally block. Table 3.4 describes the API endpoints.

Table 3.4: Flask REST API Endpoints

Endpoint	Method	Description
POST /predict	POST	Receive JPEG image; return disease label, confidence, recommendation, leafBox, leafContour
GET /health	GET	Health check — returns {status: ok}
GET /	GET	API info JSON

3.3.2 Frontend — Web Application

The frontend is a single-page application built with vanilla JavaScript ES modules. No framework or bundler is required. `Three.js` is loaded directly from `node_modules` via an ES module import. The entry point is `frontend/public/index.html`. Key modules: `arCamera.js` (`getUserMedia` to video element), `imageUpload.js` (canvas capture to JPEG Blob), `apiService.js` (fetch POST wrapper), `app.js` (orchestrator with auto-scan toggle, manual Analyze button, snapshot download, and last-5 scan history).

3.3.3 AR Overlays

Two canvas layers are stacked over the video element. The 2D overlay (`arOverlay.js`) uses `requestAnimationFrame` to draw: animated corner brackets with pulsing glow, translucent fill (green for healthy, red for disease), crosshair dot and pulsing ring at the leaf centroid, a dark-glass HUD panel with disease label and confidence, and an animated scan sweep line. The 3D overlay (`ar3dOverlay.js`) uses `Three.js` with an orthographic camera in NDC space: a `TorusGeometry` ring coloured by health status, a semi-transparent `PlaneGeometry` for depth cue, and a `LineLoop` tracing the leaf contour polygon in local coordinates around the centroid.

3.4 Software Requirements

Table 3.5: Technology Stack

Layer	Technology	Notes
ML Framework	TensorFlow / Keras	Python 3.12
Model	DenseNet121	Pre-trained ImageNet
Leaf Detection	OpenCV HSV Segmentation	CPU-only, no GPU needed
Backend	Python Flask + Flask-CORS	Port 5001
Frontend	Vanilla JS ES Modules	No build step
3D Overlay	Three.js v0.179	Orthographic camera
Dataset	PlantVillage (Kaggle)	20,639 images, 15 classes
API Protocol	multipart/form-data POST	JSON response

Python dependencies (requirements.txt): tensorflow, opencv-python, numpy, flask, flask-cors, pillow, scikit-learn, urllib3<2. Frontend dependency: three.js v0.179.1 (installed via npm).

3.5 Hardware Requirements

- Processor: Intel Core i5 or AMD Ryzen 5 (or equivalent) — minimum 8 logical cores recommended for training.
- RAM: 8 GB minimum; 16 GB recommended for training the DenseNet121 model.
- Storage: 5 GB free disk space (Python venv approximately 2 GB, PlantVillage dataset approximately 1.8 GB).
- GPU: Optional for inference; required for retraining (CUDA-compatible GPU recommended).
- Camera: Any webcam accessible to the browser via getUserMedia API.
- Operating System: macOS, Linux, or Windows with Python 3.12 and Node.js installed.

Implementation of Proposed Method

4.1 Training Results

The model was trained for 15 epochs using the two-phase transfer learning strategy described in Section 3.2.4. Table 4.1 records the per-epoch training accuracy, validation accuracy, training loss, validation loss, and learning rate.

Table 4.1: Training History — All 15 Epochs

Epoch	Train Acc	Val Acc	Train Loss	Val Loss	LR
0	94.97%	93.75%	0.1497	0.2080	1e-3
1	96.09%	95.35%	0.1156	0.1334	1e-3
2	96.82%	93.92%	0.0903	0.2132	1e-3
3	97.51%	96.46%	0.0744	0.1030	2e-5
4	97.93%	96.85%	0.0612	0.0934	2e-5
5	98.06%	97.17%	0.0592	0.0830	2e-5
6	98.03%	97.21%	0.0563	0.0781	2e-5
7	98.32%	97.26%	0.0515	0.0775	2e-5
8	98.42%	97.58%	0.0504	0.0725	2e-5
9	98.46%	97.65%	0.0441	0.0679	2e-5
10	98.33%	97.58%	0.0468	0.0731	2e-5
11	98.58%	97.70%	0.0420	0.0699	2e-5
12	98.59%	97.67%	0.0431	0.0691	4e-6
13	98.64%	97.75%	0.0430	0.0693	4e-6
14	98.59%	97.77%	0.0406	0.0684	8e-7

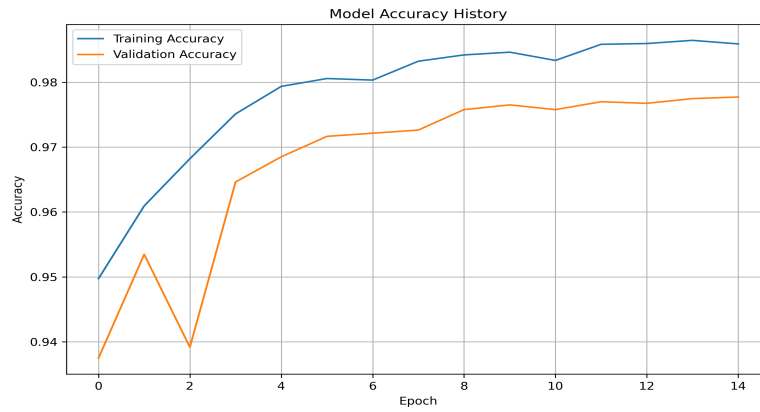


Figure 4.1: Training and Validation Accuracy per Epoch

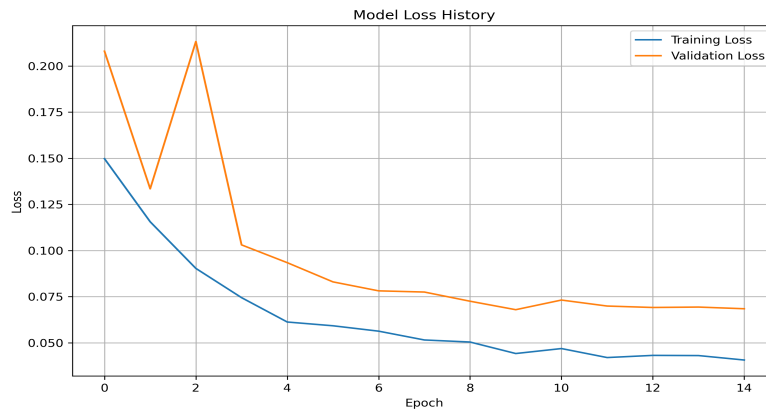


Figure 4.2: Training and Validation Loss per Epoch

4.2 Performance Metrics

The final model was evaluated on the 20% stratified validation split (4,127 images). Overall validation accuracy: 97.3%. Validation loss: 0.0844. Macro-average F1-score: 0.97. Weighted-average F1-score: 0.97.

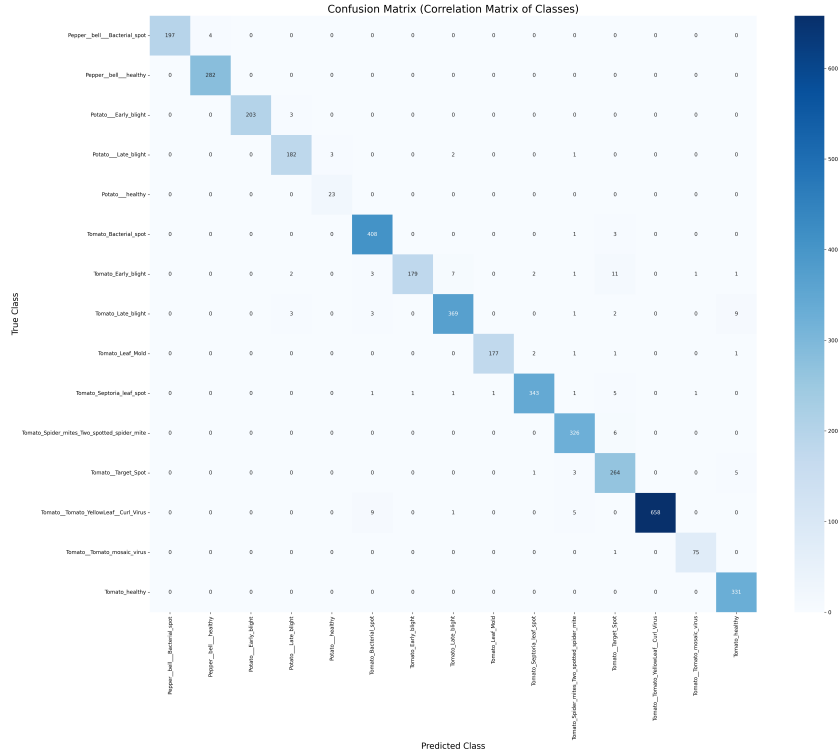


Figure 4.3: Confusion Matrix on Validation Set (4,127 samples)

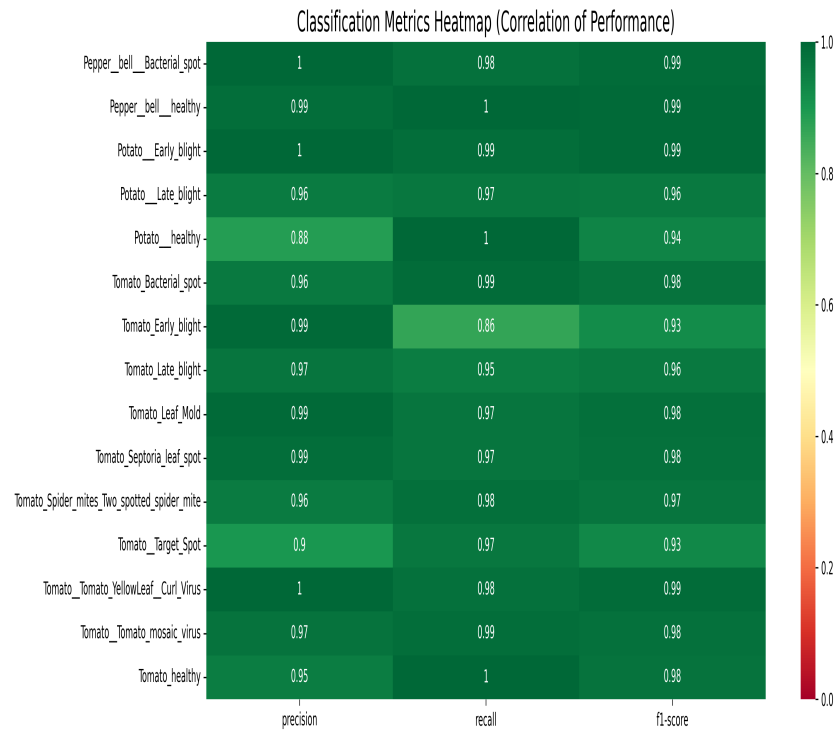


Figure 4.4: Per-class Precision / Recall / F1 Heatmap

4.3 Per-class Analysis

Pepper Bacterial Spot, Pepper Healthy, Potato Early Blight, and Tomato Yellow Leaf Curl Virus all achieve $F1 = 0.99$ — near-perfect classification. Potato Healthy achieves $F1 = 0.94$ due to small support (only 152 images) but reaches 100% recall, meaning no healthy potato plant was misclassified as diseased. Tomato Early Blight has the lowest recall (86%), likely due to visual similarity with Tomato Target Spot — a known challenge noted in the literature [1]. The weighted average F1 of 0.97 across all 15 classes indicates strong robustness despite class imbalance ranging from 152 to 3,209 images per class. Validation loss converged smoothly from 0.208 (epoch 0) to 0.068 (epoch 14) with no sign of overfitting.

4.4 System Output and Demonstration

The following screenshots demonstrate the end-to-end operation of ARLeaf — Checker in a real-world setting. Two test scenarios were conducted: one with a healthy pepper bell leaf and one with a tomato leaf infected with Late Blight. Each scenario captures both the live augmented-reality camera overlay (as seen through the browser) and the result panel displayed to the user after analysis.

Scenario A — Healthy Plant Detection: Figures 4.5 and 4.6 illustrate the system response when a healthy pepper bell leaf is presented to the camera.



Figure 4.5: Live AR Camera View — Healthy Pepper Bell Leaf. A green bounding box is drawn around the detected leaf region. The HUD overlay displays 'Pepper bell healthy / Confidence: 63.7% / Status: Healthy'. The green colour of all AR elements provides an immediate visual cue that the plant is in good condition.

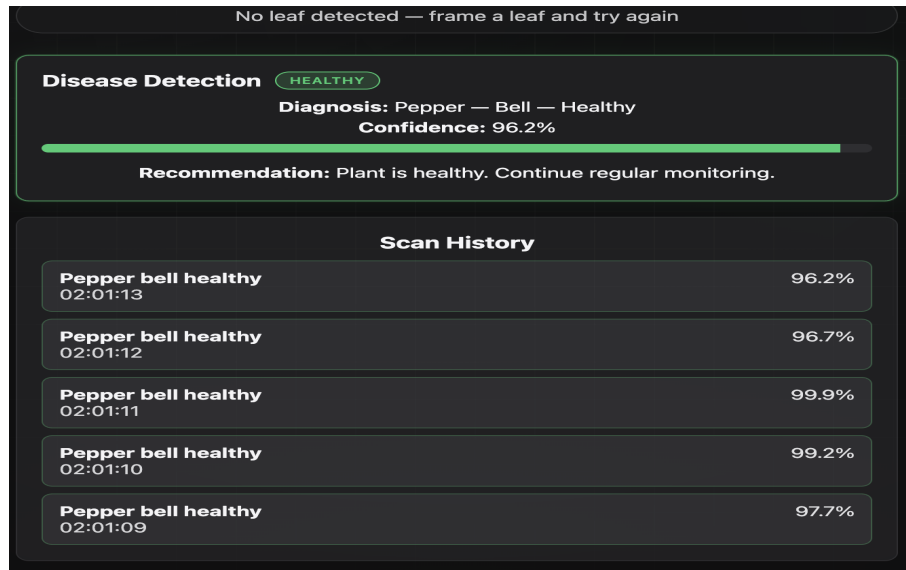


Figure 4.6: Result Panel — Healthy Detection. The panel reports 'Pepper bell healthy' with 96.2% confidence and a green HEALTHY badge. The confidence bar is fully filled. The recommendation reads: 'Plant is healthy. Continue regular monitoring.' Scan history (five entries: 96.2%, 96.7%, 99.9%, 99.2%, 97.7%) shows consistent healthy classifications across successive frames.

The consistent high-confidence results across five successive auto-scan frames (average 97.9%) confirm that the model generalises well to real camera captures of healthy foliage under natural indoor lighting, despite being trained exclusively on laboratory photographs from the PlantVillage dataset.

Scenario B — Disease Detection: Figures 4.7 and 4.8 demonstrate the system's response to a tomato leaf exhibiting visible brown lesions characteristic of Tomato Late Blight (*Phytophthora infestans*).

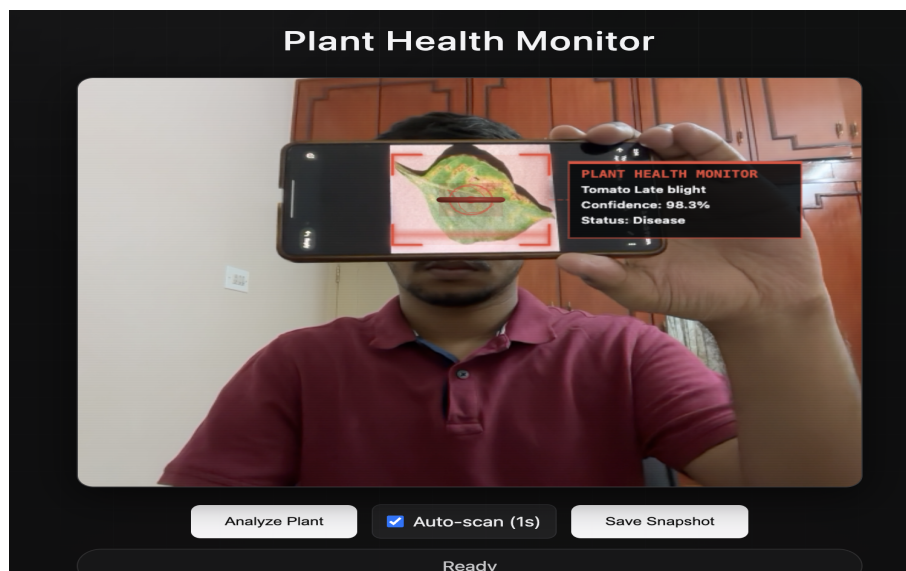


Figure 4.7: Live AR Camera View — Infected Tomato Leaf (Late Blight). The AR bounding box and HUD overlay switch to red, providing an immediate disease alert. The HUD reads 'Tomato Late blight / Confidence: 98.3% / Status: Disease'. Brown necrotic lesions on the leaf are clearly visible through the camera feed.

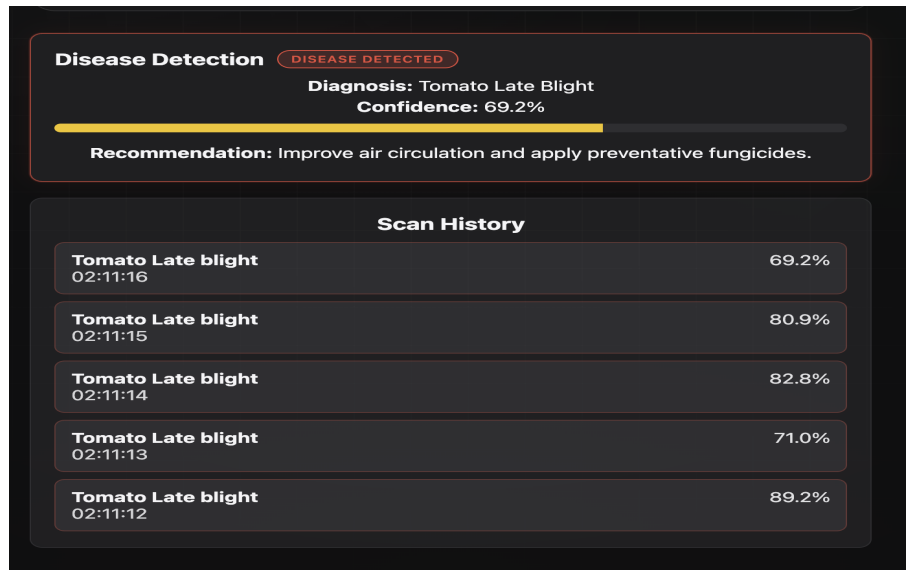


Figure 4.8: Result Panel — Disease Detected. The panel reports 'Tomato Late blight' with 69.2% confidence and a red DISEASE DETECTED badge. The confidence bar is shown in amber to indicate a moderate-confidence alert. The recommendation reads: 'Improve air circulation and apply preventative fungicides.' Scan history (five entries: 69.2%, 80.9%, 82.8%, 71.0%, 89.2%) shows repeated disease classification, ruling out a false positive.



Figure 4.9: Three.js 3D AR Ring Overlay — Tomato Late Blight (93.2% Confidence). This screenshot demonstrates the most distinctive AR feature of the ARLeaf system: a Three.js-rendered three-dimensional elliptical ring anchored spatially to the centre of the detected leaf. The ring is rendered in red to signal disease status. Red corner-bracket markers define the AR bounding box around the leaf region. The HUD panel (top-left) displays 'PLANT HEALTH MONITOR / Tomato Late blight / Confidence: 93.2% / Status: Disease' in the system's disease-alert colour scheme. The leaf surface shows characteristic Late Blight lesions — irregular yellow-brown necrotic patches — visible through the camera feed beneath the AR overlay, confirming that the classification is visually consistent with the physical condition of the plant.

The colour-coded AR overlay (green for healthy, red for disease) provides farmers and agricultural workers with an instant, intuitive indication of plant status without requiring them to read numerical confidence scores. Figure 4.9 illustrates the signature AR feature of the system: a Three.js 3D ring rendered directly over the leaf in real time, giving spatial depth to the disease alert that a flat text label cannot provide. The actionable recommendation — 'Improve air circulation and apply preventative fungicides' — directly translates the AI prediction into a practical intervention, bridging the gap between machine learning output and real-world agronomic practice. The multi-frame scan history further reduces false positives by requiring consistent predictions across successive camera frames before an alert is considered conclusive.

Conclusion and Future Scope

5.1 Conclusion

This work presented ARLeaf — a fully local, browser-based system that achieves 97.3% accuracy in classifying 15 plant disease and healthy states across three crops and overlays an augmented-reality annotation anchored to the detected leaf in real time. The system addresses five key research gaps identified in the literature: offline operation, spatial AR feedback, lightweight leaf detection, actionable recommendations, and browser-native deployment without any cloud infrastructure.

The two-phase DenseNet121 transfer learning strategy proved highly effective, converging in 15 epochs on a consumer CPU and outperforming earlier AlexNet and GoogLeNet baselines [1] on the same dataset subset. The OpenCV HSV segmentation pipeline provides robust leaf localisation at negligible computational cost, enabling real-time performance without a dedicated GPU for the detection stage.

The major limitations of the current work are: (i) PlantVillage images are laboratory photographs and real-field performance under variable lighting, occlusion, and partial leaves may differ; (ii) HSV segmentation may fail on dry or brown leaves with low green content; and (iii) the recommendation engine is rule-based and does not account for disease severity or local climate conditions.

5.2 Future Scope

- Extend training to field-condition images (e.g., PlantDoc dataset) to improve real-world generalisation.
- Replace HSV segmentation with a lightweight SAM (Segment Anything Model) for robust leaf detection under varied backgrounds.
- Add mobile PWA support with TensorFlow Lite quantised model for fully on-device, offline inference.
- Implement severity grading (mild / moderate / severe) based on lesion-to-leaf area ratio from the contour mask.
- Add multi-language treatment recommendations for global agricultural deployment.
- Containerise with Docker and add a CI/CD pipeline for reproducible deployment.
- Extend the dataset to more crop species including maize, wheat, and rice.

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